

Word family: **stomach / stomachs / stomached / stomaching**

Base word: stomach

Part of speech: mainly **noun**, also **verb**

Related forms:

* **stomach** (n.) — 胃；腹部；食慾；承受能力

* **stomach** (v.) — 忍受；接受

* **stomachache / stomach ache** (n.) — 胃痛；肚痛

* **stomach upset / upset stomach** — 腸胃不適

* **stomach-churning** (adj.) — 令人作嘔的；令人極度不安的

* **stomach-turning** (adj.) — 令人反胃的；令人噁心的

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **stomach pain**

* **stomach ache**

* **empty stomach**

* **full stomach**

* **on an empty stomach**

* **upset stomach**

* **a knot in your stomach**

* **butterflies in your stomach**

* **turn your stomach**

* **make your stomach turn**

* **have no stomach for**

* **can't stomach something**

* **stomach something**

* **stomach-churning**

* **stomach-turning**

Meaning in this passage

> For a moment, I just froze and felt a knot in my **stomach**.

Here, **stomach** is part of the expression:

a knot in your stomach = 因緊張、震驚、害怕或壓力而感到胃部發緊

The speaker had just been publicly and unfairly accused, so the emotional shock created a strong physical sensation.

中文翻譯：

那一刻我整個人有點愣住，心裏也像打了一個結一樣。

So here:

stomach = 胃部 / 上腹部，而整個片語形容強烈焦慮所造成的緊縮感

1. **stomach (胃) — 胃**

This is the core anatomical sense.

Practice 1

> Food passes into the **stomach** after you swallow it.

食物吞下後會進入**胃**。

Practice 2

> He had pain in his **stomach**.

他的**胃部**感到疼痛。

Practice 3

> The doctor examined her **stomach**.

醫生檢查了她的**胃部 / 腹部**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stomach = 消化系統中接收和消化食物的器官****

2. **stomach (腹部；肚子) — 肚；腹部**

In everyday speech, **stomach** often refers more loosely to the front abdominal area, not strictly the organ.

Practice 1

> He was lying on his **stomach**.

他**趴着**躺下。

Practice 2

> She put her hand on her ****stomach****.

她把手放在****肚子 / 腹部****上。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stomach = everyday use: the front part of the body below the chest****

中文：

****日常用法中可泛指腹部或肚子****

3. ****lie on your stomach — 趴着；俯臥****

Practice 1

> The baby was lying on his ****stomach****.

嬰兒正****趴着****。

Practice 2

> I can't sleep comfortably on my ****stomach****.

我不習慣****趴着睡****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****lie on your stomach = 身體前面朝下俯臥****

4. ****stomach pain — 胃痛 / 腹痛****

Practice 1

> She complained of ****stomach pain****.

她說自己有****胃痛 / 腹痛****。

Practice 2

> Severe ****stomach pain**** should not be ignored.

嚴重**腹痛**不應忽視。

MCQ-ready definition:

stomach pain = 胃部或腹部感到疼痛

5. **stomachache / stomach ache — 胃痛；肚痛**

Practice 1

> I have a **stomach ache**.

我**肚痛 / 胃痛**。

Practice 2

> Too much rich food gave him a **stomachache**.

吃太多油膩食物令他**肚痛**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stomachache = 胃部或腹部的疼痛

6. **empty stomach — 空腹**

Practice 1

> Don't take this medicine on an **empty stomach**.

不要**空腹**服用這種藥。

Practice 2

> Coffee on an **empty stomach** makes me uncomfortable.

空腹喝咖啡會令我不舒服。

MCQ-ready definition:

empty stomach = 胃裏幾乎沒有食物的狀態

7. ****full stomach — 飽腹；吃飽了的胃****

Practice 1

> It's hard to exercise on a ****full stomach****.

吃得很飽時很難運動。

Practice 2

> I fell asleep with a ****full stomach****.

我吃得很飽便睡着了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****full stomach = 吃過很多東西、胃裏充滿食物的狀態****

8. ****upset stomach — 腸胃不適****

Practice 1

> I have an ****upset stomach****.

我有點****腸胃不適****。

Practice 2

> The food gave him an ****upset stomach****.

那些食物令他****腸胃不舒服****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****upset stomach = 胃腸感到不適，可能包括噁心、胃痛或消化不良****

9. ****a knot in your stomach — 胃裏一緊；緊張得肚子發緊****

This is the exact expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I felt ****a knot in my stomach****.

我感到**胃裏一緊 / 心裏揪住**。

Practice 2

> I get **a knot in my stomach** before important interviews.

重要面試前，我總會**緊張得胃裏發緊**。

Practice 3

> The accusation left me with **a knot in my stomach**.

那項指責令我**胃裏一緊、非常不安**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a knot in your stomach = 因焦慮、害怕或壓力而產生的胃部緊縮感****

10. ****butterflies in your stomach — 緊張得心裏七上八下；既緊張又興奮****

Practice 1

> I always get ****butterflies in my stomach**** before going on stage.

上台前我總會**緊張得心裏七上八下**。

Practice 2

> She had ****butterflies in her stomach**** before the date.

約會前她感到**既緊張又興奮**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****butterflies in your stomach = 因期待、緊張或興奮而出現輕微翻騰感****

11. ****stomach (食慾 / 進食能力) — 胃口；承受食物的能力****

Practice 1

> I don't have much ****stomach for food**** today.

我今天沒甚麼**胃口**。

Practice 2

> After seeing that, I had no ****stomach for dinner****.

看完那件事後，我完全沒有****胃口吃晚飯****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stomach for food = 想吃或能夠吃東西的胃口 / 能力****

12. ****have no stomach for something — 沒有心情 / 膽量 / 意願做某事****

A major figurative idiom.

Practice 1

> I have no ****stomach for another argument****.

我已經沒有心情再****吵一場****。

Practice 2

> He had no ****stomach for a fight****.

他沒有****打下去的膽量 / 意願****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****have no stomach for X = 沒有意願、膽量或心理承受力去面對 X****

13. ****have the stomach for something — 有膽量 / 承受力面對某事****

Practice 1

> You need a strong ****stomach for this kind of work****.

做這類工作需要很強的****心理承受力****。

Practice 2

> Not everyone has the ****stomach for confrontation****.

不是每個人都有****面對衝突的膽量****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****have the stomach for X = 有足夠心理承受力或膽量面對令人不舒服的事情****

14. ****stomach (verb : 忍受 ; 接受) — 忍受 ; 受得了****

A major figurative verb sense.

Practice 1

> I can't ****stomach his dishonesty****.

我****受不了****他的不誠實。

Practice 2

> She couldn't ****stomach the idea**** of working with him again.

她無法****接受 / 忍受****再次和他共事這個想法。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stomach something = 忍受、接受某件令人反感、不舒服或難以接受的事****

15. ****can't stomach something — 受不了某事****

Practice 1

> I can't ****stomach that kind of behaviour****.

我****受不了那種行為****。

Practice 2

> He couldn't ****stomach the hypocrisy****.

他無法****忍受那種虛偽****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****can't stomach X = 對 X 反感到難以接受或忍受****

16. ****turn your stomach — 令人反胃 ; 令人作嘔****

Practice 1

> The smell **turned my stomach**.

那股氣味令我**反胃**。

Practice 2

> The sight was enough to **turn your stomach**.

那個畫面足以令人**作嘔**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****turn someone's stomach = 令某人感到噁心、反胃或極度厭惡****

17. ****make your stomach turn — 令人反胃 / 噁心****

Practice 1

> The smell **made my stomach turn**.

那股味道令我**胃裏翻騰、想吐**。

Practice 2

> The cruelty in the story **made my stomach turn**.

故事中的殘酷內容令我**極度反感**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****make someone's stomach turn = 令某人生理上噁心或心理上極度厭惡****

18. ****stomach-churning — 令人作嘔的；令人極度不安的****

Practice 1

> The documentary included some ****stomach-churning scenes****.

紀錄片中有一些****令人反胃的場面****。

Practice 2

> It was a **stomach-churning experience**.

那是一段**令人極度不安 / 反胃的經歷**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stomach-churning = 強烈到令人噁心、恐懼或不舒服的

19. **stomach-turning** — 令人噁心的；令人反胃的

Practice 1

> The smell was **stomach-turning**.

那股氣味**令人反胃**。

Practice 2

> The report contained some **stomach-turning details**.

報告中有一些**令人作嘔的細節**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stomach-turning = disgusting enough to make someone feel physically or emotionally sick

20. **stomach** (勇氣 / 心理承受力) — 膽量；承受力

This underlies expressions such as **have the stomach for**.

Practice 1

> He didn't have the **stomach** to continue.

他沒有足夠**膽量 / 心理承受力**繼續下去。

Practice 2

> It takes some **stomach** to face that kind of criticism.

要面對那種批評，需要相當的**心理承受力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****stomach = figurative: willingness or courage to face something unpleasant****

Important distinction 1: ****stomach vs abdomen****

****stomach****

can mean the internal digestive organ, but in everyday speech may loosely mean 肚子.

****abdomen****

the anatomical body region between chest and pelvis.

So:

> stomach = 胃 / 日常的肚子

> abdomen = 腹部 (較醫學 / 正式)

Important distinction 2: ****stomach vs belly****

****stomach****

neutral/common.

****belly****

more informal and refers to the external abdomen, not specifically the organ.

> belly button

肚臍

> stomach pain

胃痛 / 腹痛

Important distinction 3: ****stomach vs tummy****

****tummy****

informal, gentle, often used with children.

stomach

neutral standard English.

> tummy ache

肚痛 (較口語 / 兒童)

> stomach ache

胃痛 / 肚痛

Important distinction 4: **a knot in your stomach vs stomachache**

a knot in your stomach

usually emotional tightness caused by anxiety.

stomachache

actual physical pain.

In your passage, the cause is emotional shock, so **a knot in my stomach** is figurative.

Important distinction 5: **a knot in your stomach vs butterflies in your stomach**

knot

stronger, tighter, more unpleasant anxiety.

butterflies

lighter nervous excitement; may even be positive.

Public accusation → **knot**

First date / performance excitement → often **butterflies**

Important distinction 6: **upset stomach vs upset person**

upset stomach

腸胃不適

upset person

情緒不快 / 難過

Same adjective, completely different domain.

Important distinction 7: **can't stomach vs can't stand**

Very close.

can't stomach

strong disgust or deep unwillingness to accept.

can't stand

broad inability to tolerate.

> I can't stand the noise.

我受不了噪音。

> I can't stomach his cruelty.

我實在無法接受他的殘忍。

Stomach often carries stronger disgust.

Important distinction 8: **stomach as verb is not about digestion**

> I can't stomach it.

does not mean 「我的胃不能消化它」 literally.

It means:

我無法忍受 / 接受它

This figurative sense comes from the idea of being able to physically “take” something into your stomach.

Important distinction 9: ****turn your stomach = disgust, not necessarily illness****

The phrase can be:

Physical

bad smell → nausea

Figurative

cruel behavior → disgust

So context decides whether the reaction is bodily, emotional, or both.

Important distinction 10: ****empty stomach vs hungry****

****empty stomach****

describes physical state: little/no food in stomach.

****hungry****

describes desire/need to eat.

You can technically have an empty stomach without strongly feeling hungry.

Important distinction 11: ****stomach for food vs stomach for conflict****

Literal-ish

> no stomach for food

no appetite

Figurative

> no stomach for conflict

no willingness/courage to face it

This is an important semantic extension.

Important distinction 12: ****stomach pain vs stomach upset****

****stomach pain****

specifically pain.

****upset stomach****

broader digestive discomfort; may include:

- * nausea
- * cramps
- * indigestion
- * diarrhea

They are not identical.

Family-extension note

****Stomach**** has several strong modern branches:

1. ****digestive organ****

- * stomach
- * stomach pain
- * stomach ache

2. ****everyday abdomen****

- * lie on your stomach
- * hand on your stomach

3. ****physical digestive state****

- * empty stomach
- * full stomach
- * upset stomach

4. **emotion felt physically**

- * knot in your stomach
- * butterflies in your stomach

5. **appetite / willingness**

- * no stomach for food

6. **courage / psychological tolerance**

- * have no stomach for conflict
- * have the stomach for something

7. **verb: tolerate**

- * can't stomach something

8. **disgust**

- * turn your stomach
- * stomach-churning
- * stomach-turning

The figurative extensions all grow naturally from the idea that strong emotion and disgust can be **felt physically in the stomach**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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stomach (organ)	胃	digestive organ	
stomach (body area)	肚子；腹部	everyday abdomen	
lie on your stomach	趴着；俯臥	body position	
stomach pain	胃痛 / 腹痛	physical pain	
stomachache	胃痛；肚痛	pain	
empty stomach	空腹	no food	
full stomach	飽腹	full of food	
upset stomach	腸胃不適	digestive discomfort	
knot in your stomach	胃裏一緊；心裏揪住	anxiety	
butterflies in your stomach	緊張又興奮	nervous excitement	
no stomach for food	沒胃口	appetite	
have no stomach for X	沒膽量 / 沒意願面對 X	tolerance/courage	

have the stomach for X	有承受力面對 X	willingness	
stomach (verb)	忍受；接受	tolerate	
can't stomach X	受不了 X	strong intolerance	
turn your stomach	令人反胃	disgust	
make your stomach turn	令人噁心 / 反感	nausea/disgust	
stomach-churning	令人作嘔 / 極度不安的	strong reaction	
stomach-turning	令人反胃的	disgusting	

For your original sentence

> For a moment, I just froze and felt a knot in my **stomach**.

Here:

stomach = 胃部 / 腹部，而整個片語表示因震驚和不安而產生的緊縮感

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 那一刻我整個人有點愣住，**胃裏也突然一緊**。

Or more idiomatically:

> 那一刻我整個人有點愣住，**心裏像打了一個結一樣**。

The English uses the body very vividly: the emotion is psychological, but the speaker **feels it physically in the stomach**.